Drewry

AIS Analytics

Fleet Performance Indicators | Crude Tanker | VLCC

Week 40 2026



Published on: 06 Oct, 2026

Vessel deployment | Speed | Vessel availbility | Fleet performance | Congestion, laden vessels | Congestion, ballast vessels | Glossary

92.3%

Current Utilisation

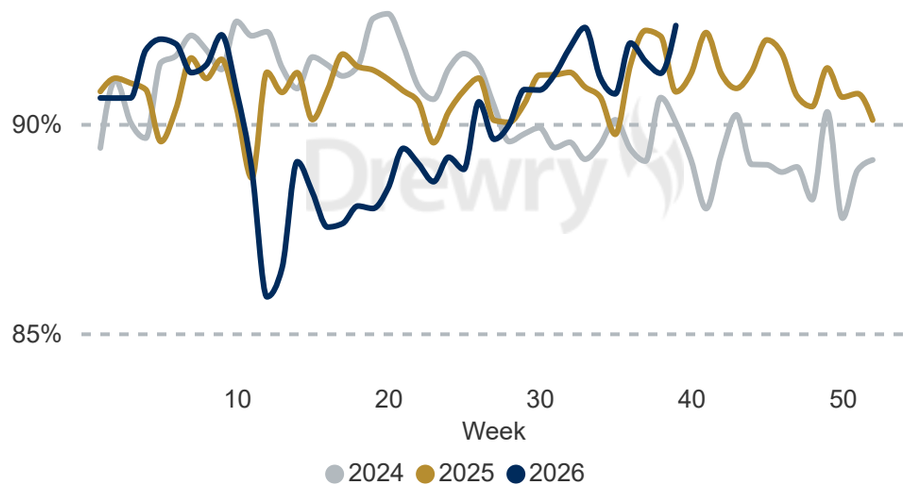
▲ 1.6

MoM percentage point change in utilisation

▲ 1.6

YoY percentage point change in utilisation

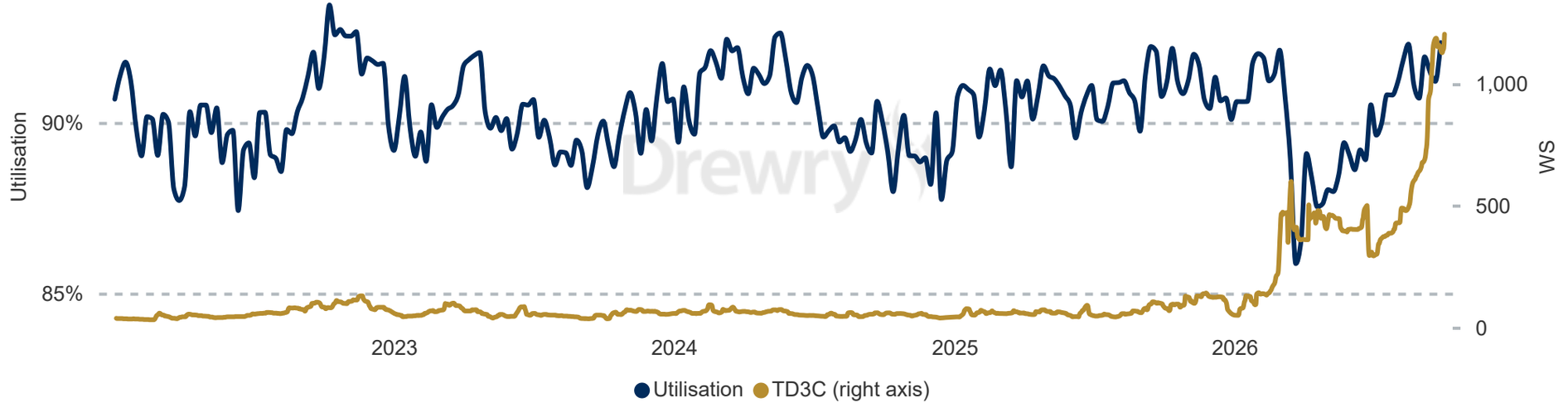
Utilisation



VLCC utilisation strengthens despite weak tonne-mile dmeand

- VLCC utilisation improved to 92.3% in week 40, up 1.6 percentage points MoM and YoY, suggesting stronger fleet employment despite subdued demand indicators. However, the tonne-mile index remained weak at 87.5, down 2.2% YoY, suggesting that reduced voyage distances and softer long-haul crude movements continue to weigh on underlying transport demand.
- Market activity showed signs of regional divergence, with vessel capacity at anchor declining by 4.1% MoM in the west and 0.5% in the east. Higher ballast speeds in the east point to active fleet repositioning and improving vessel availability, while the recovery in the tonne-mile index from recent lows indicates some improvement in cargo flows heading into the fourth quarter.
- Easing congestion and faster vessel turnaround continued to lift effective fleet supply. Lower anchorage levels, combined with elevated ballast and laden sailing speeds, increased tonnage availability across key trading regions, offsetting support from stronger utilisation and limiting the upside for VLCC freight rates despite firmer bunker prices.

Utilisation vs Baltic rates



▼ 4.1%

MoM change in vessels' capacity at anchor in West

▼ 0.5%

MoM change in vessels' capacity at anchor in East

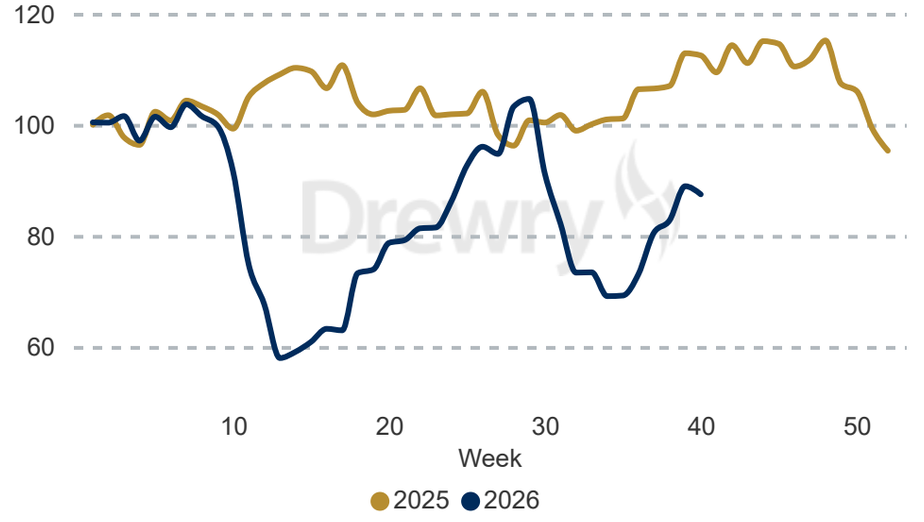
87.5

Current tonne-miles index

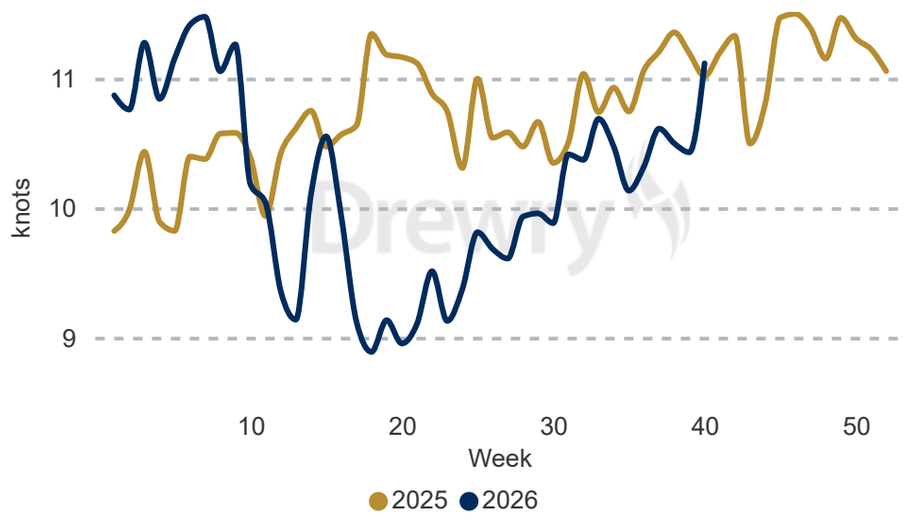
▼ 22.2%

YoY change in tonne-miles index

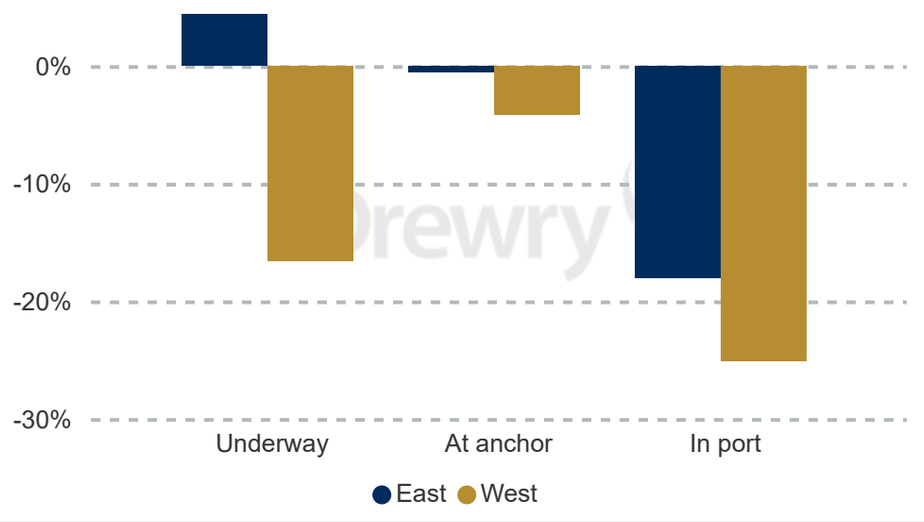
Tonne-miles index (base: week 1, 2025 =100)



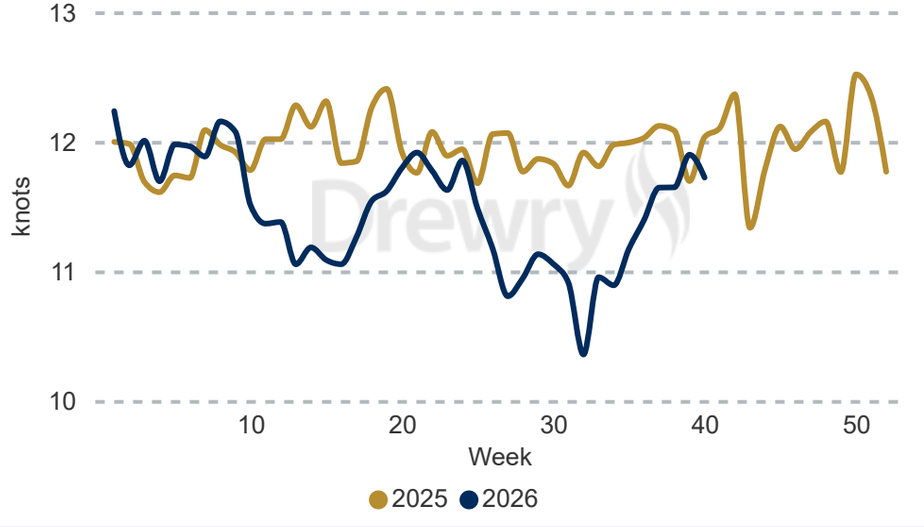
Global ballast speed



Change in trading status - MoM



Global laden speed



$866

per tonne price of bunker at the end of the week

▲ 3.3%

MoM change in bunker price

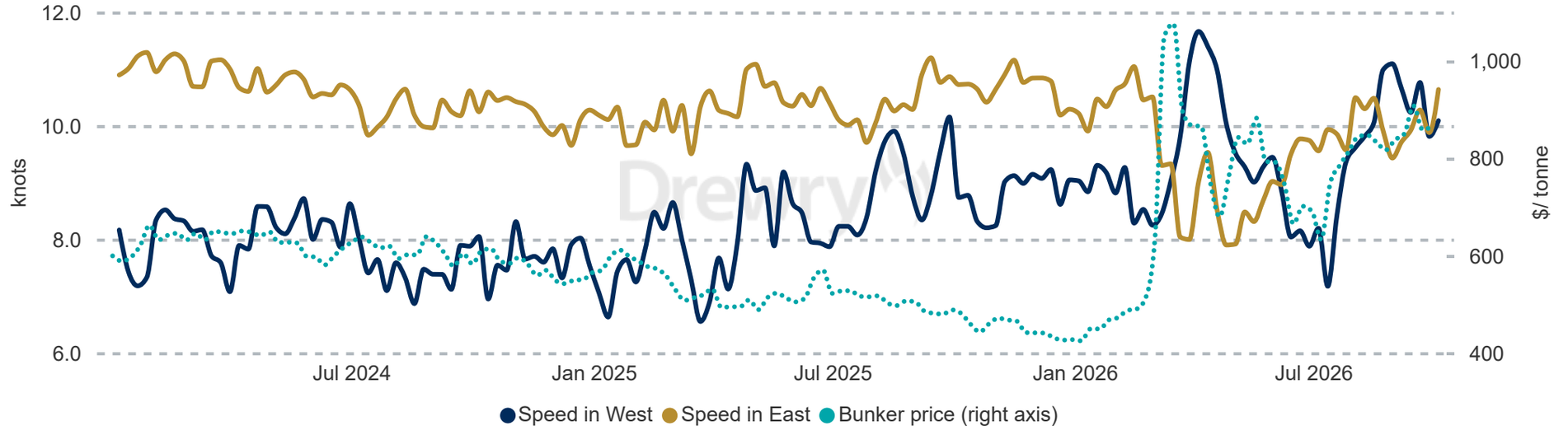
▲ 9.5%

MoM change in ballast speed in East

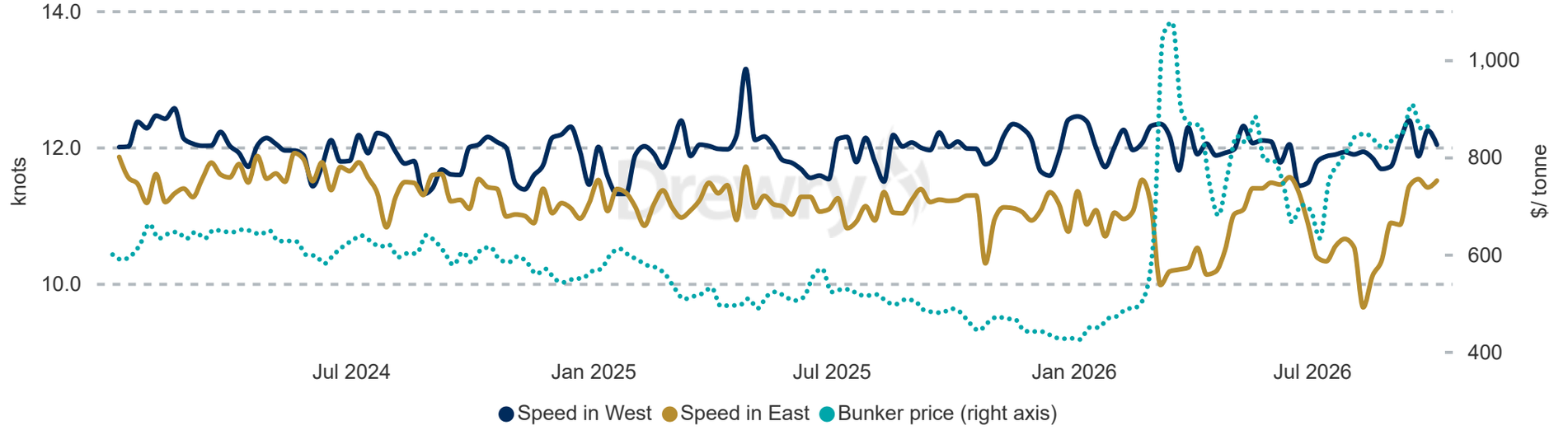
▼ 5.3%

MoM change in ballast speed in West

Ballast speed vs bunker price



Laden speed vs bunker price



▼ 5.4

mdwt change in tonnage at anchor (4-week moving average)

▼ 25.1%

change in laden anchor days (4-week moving average)

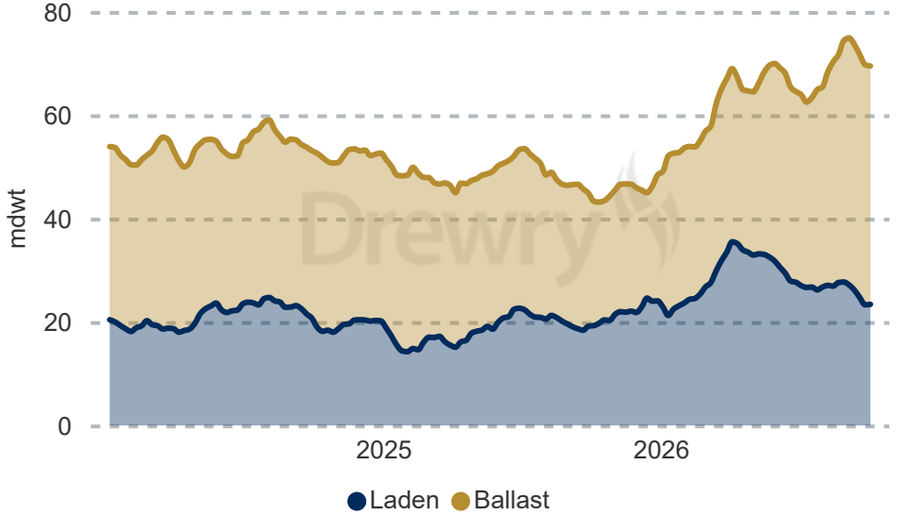
▲ 4.3

MoM percentage point change in the share of laden vessels in East

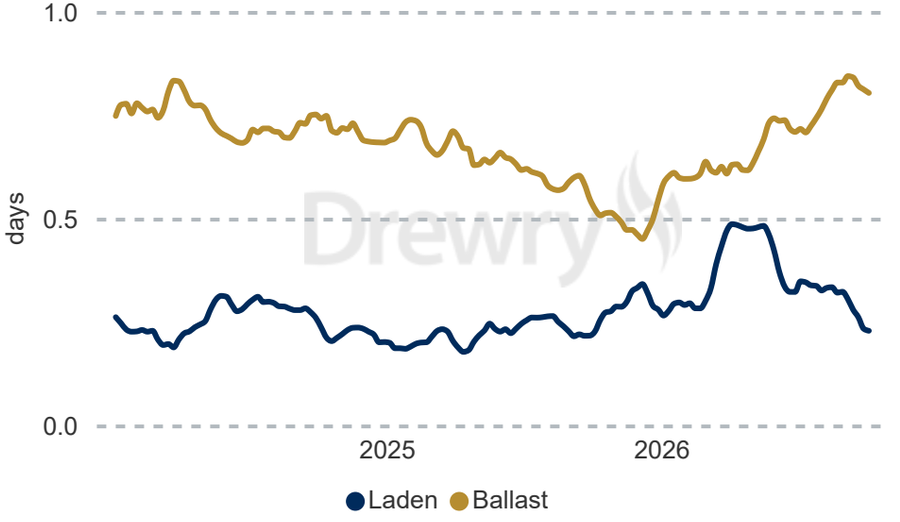
▲ 13.7

MoM percentage point change in the share of laden vessels in West

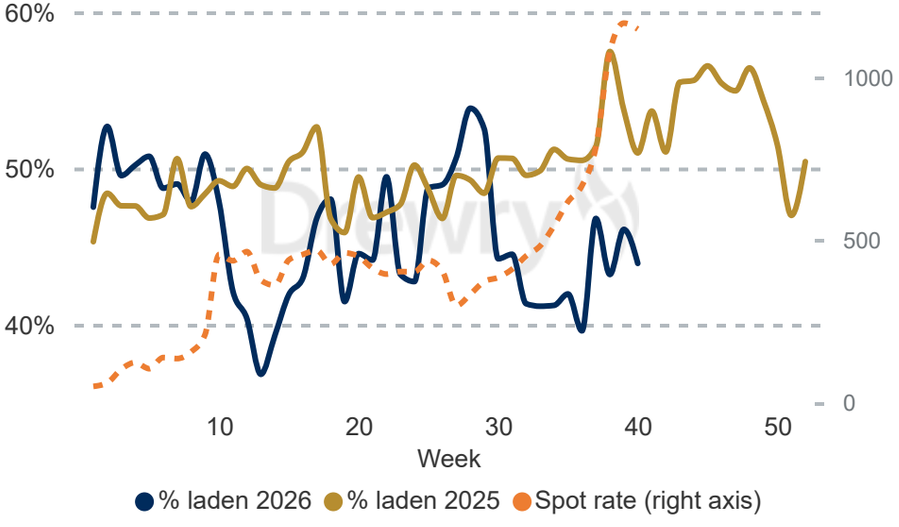
Tonnage at anchor, global- 4 week moving average



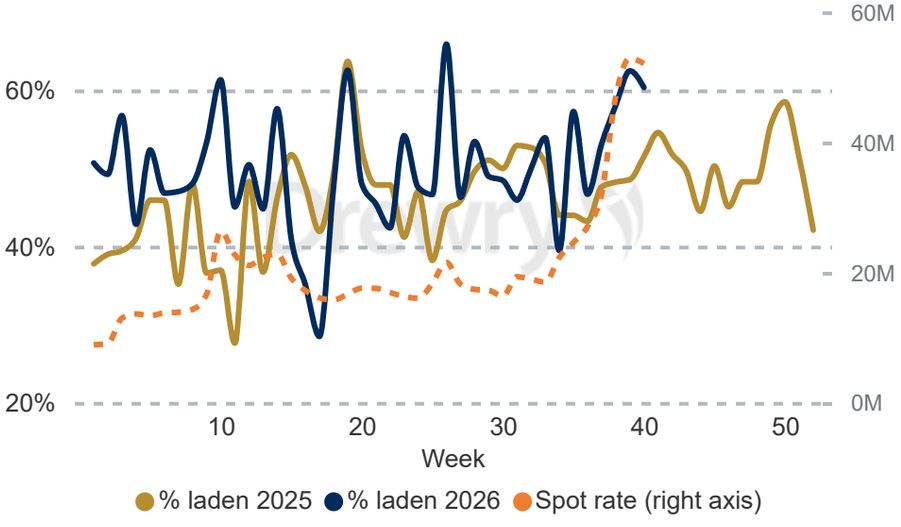
Days at anchor, global- 4 week moving average



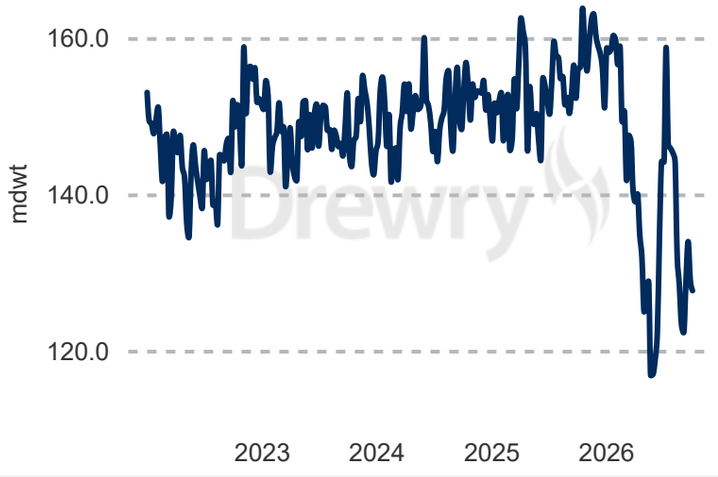
East (% laden) vsTD3C (WS)



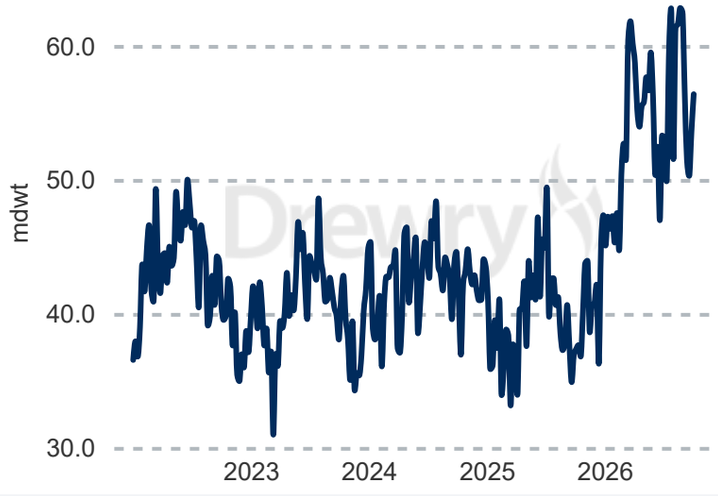
West (% laden) vsTD22 ($m)



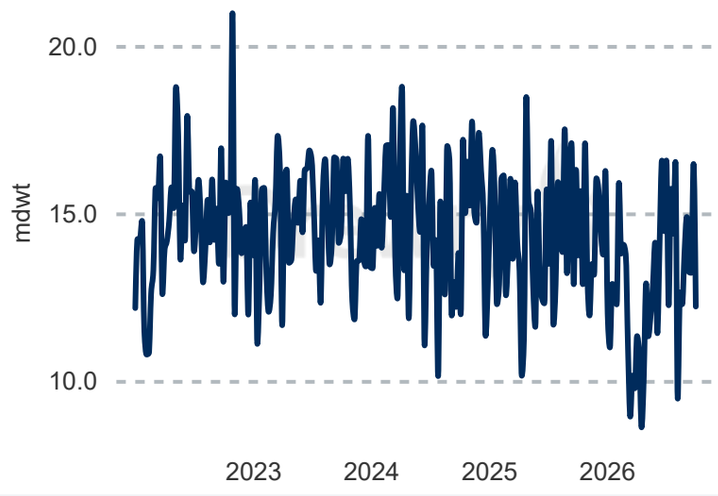
Tonnage underway, East



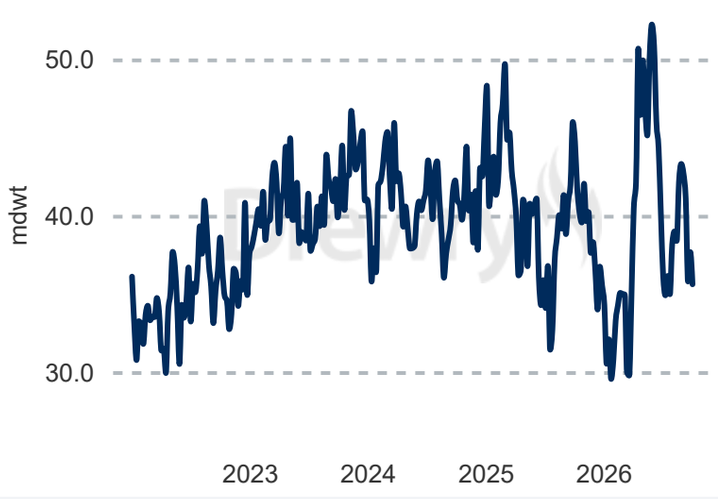
Tonnage at anchor, East



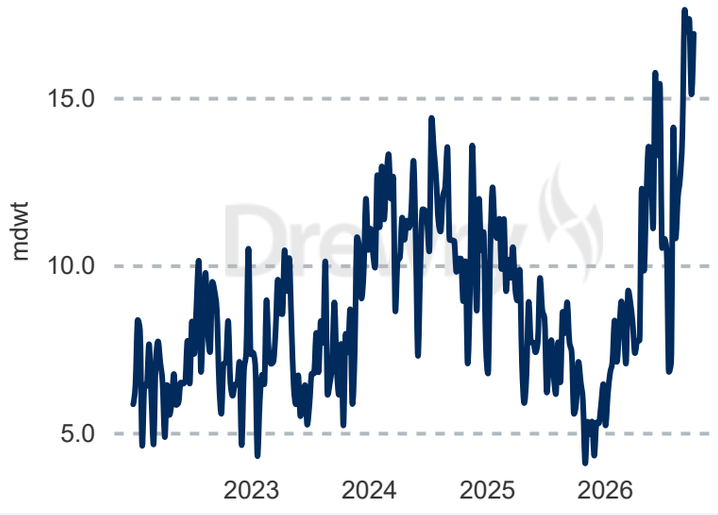
Tonnage in port, East



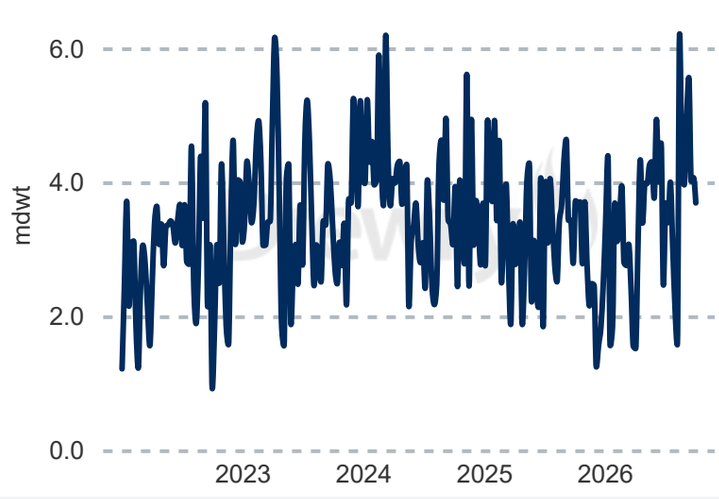
Tonnage underway, West



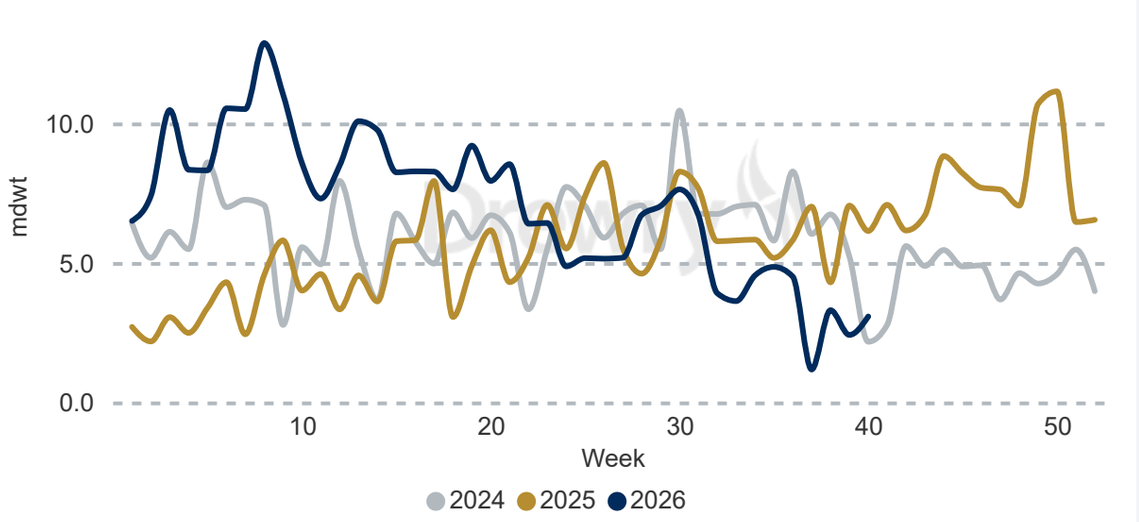
Tonnage at anchor, West



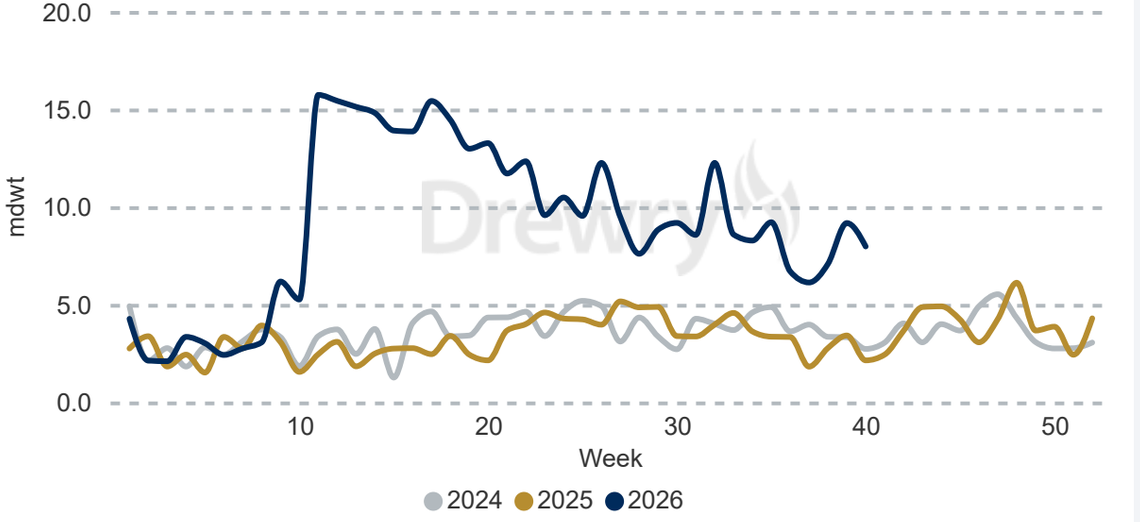
Tonnage in port, West



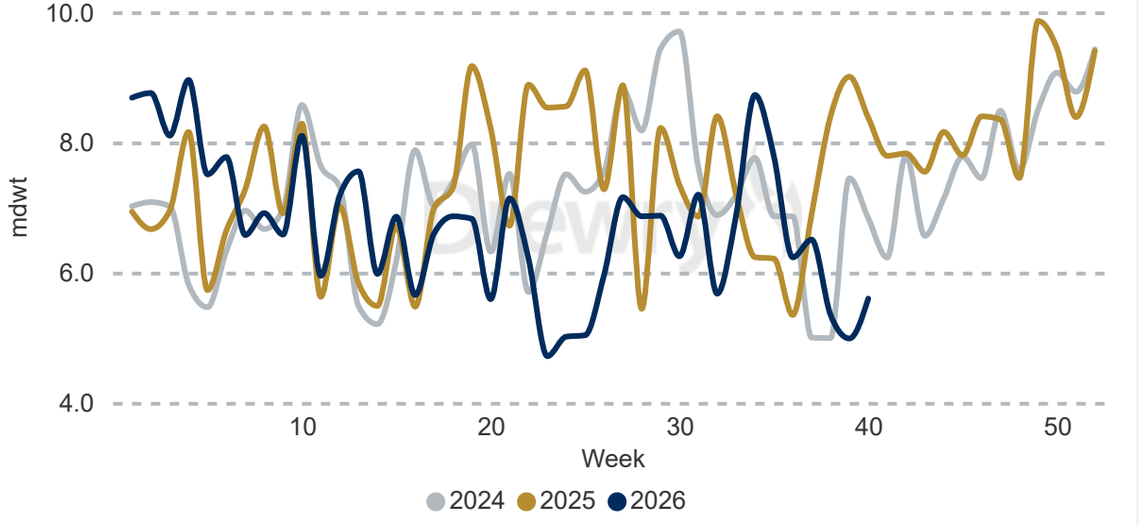
Laden tonnage at anchor in China



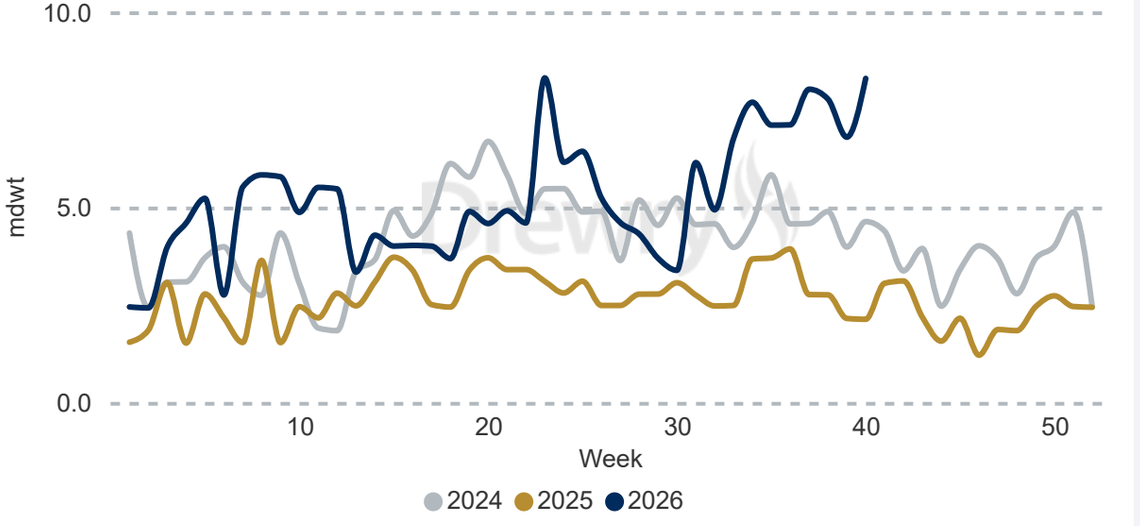
Laden tonnage at anchor in Indian



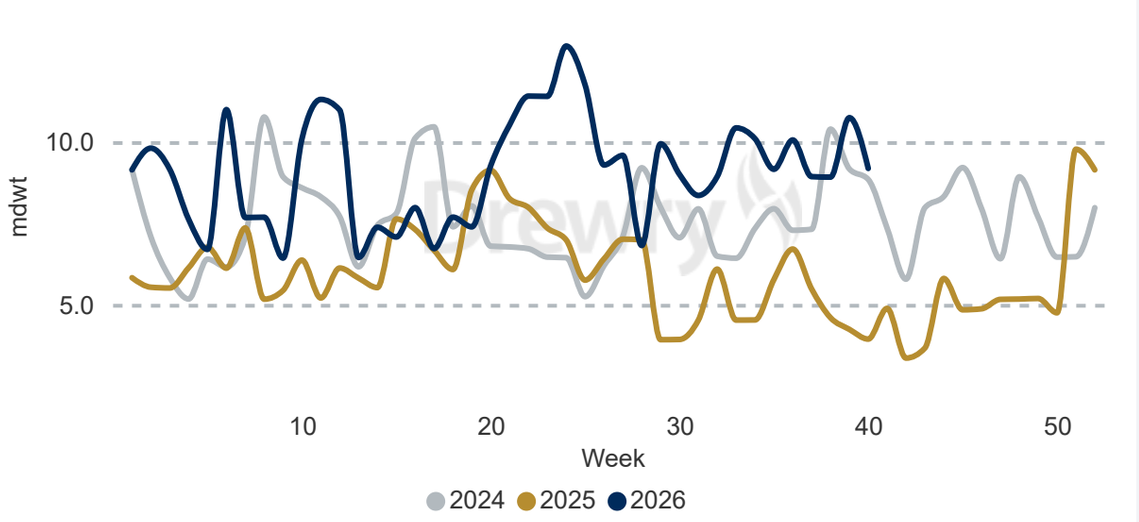
Laden tonnage at anchor in Pacific



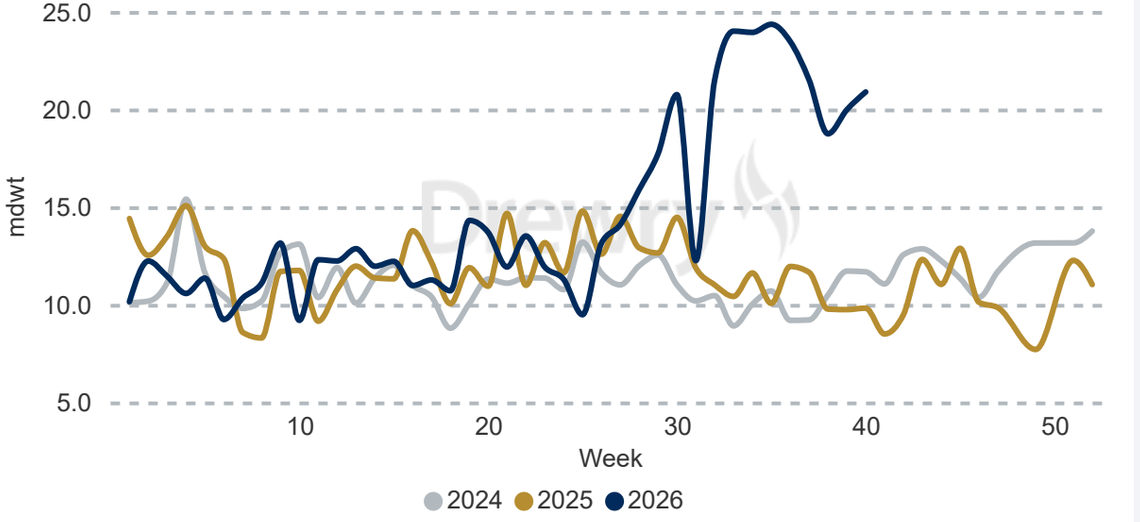
Laden tonnage at anchor in Atlantic



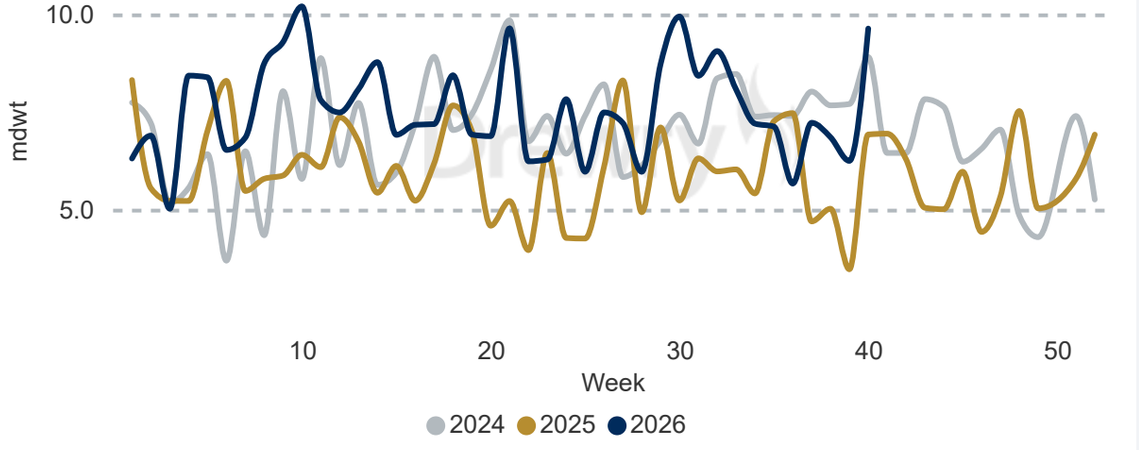
Ballast tonnage at anchor in China



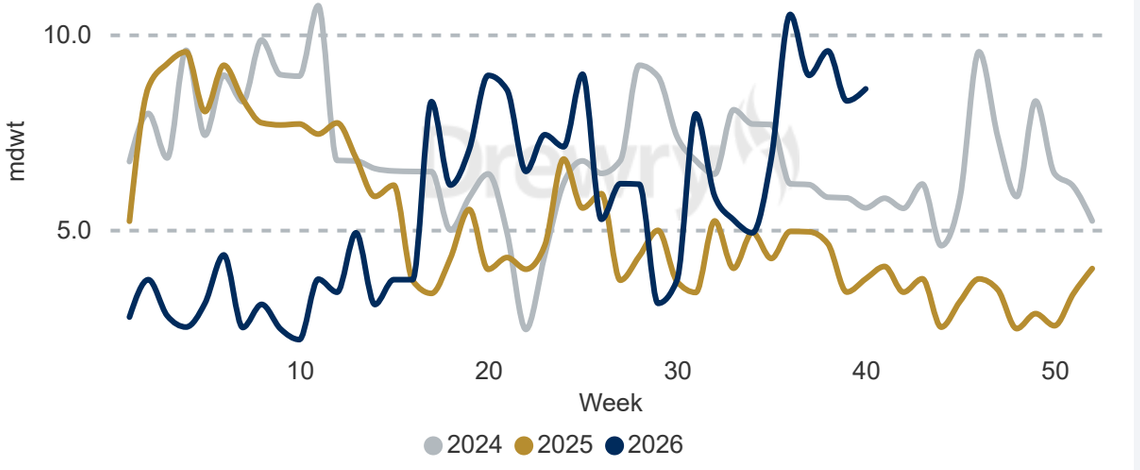
Ballast tonnage at anchor in Indian



Ballast tonnage at anchor in Pacific



Ballast tonnage at anchor in Atlantic



S No.	Terms	Define
1	VLCC vessel	All Crude tankers which are above 200,000 dwt.
2	Trading status	Status of vessels has been derived primarily from the navigation field within the AIS message. Vessels which do not have IMO number have not been included in the fleet. Furthermore, vessels that have not returned AIS message for at least 30 days, have been excluded from the analysis of fleet status while vessels that have not returned an AIS message for up to 30 days are assumed to have the same trading status as when last seen.
3	Laden dwt miles	Average distance travelled per week across the laden target fleet multiplied by the average vessel deadweight(or capacity) for that fleet
4	Bunker price	Price of the VLSFO at Singapore Port
5	% Laden	Share of laden vessels in total fleet excluding vessels under repair
6	East	East of Suez Canal and comprises China, Pacific, Indian Ocean and Oceania
7	West	West of Suez Canal and comprises Atlantic region
8	TD3C	Spot rates on the ME Gulf-China route; the data has been taken from the Baltic Exchange.
9	TD22	Spot rates on the US Gulf-China route; the data has been taken from the Baltic Exchange.
10	At anchor	Vessels with navigation status ‘At Anchor’ in the waiting zone near port area
11	Moored	Vessels moored in port for loading or discharging
12	Underway	Vessels currently at sea and are currently underway towards their destination